

various widgets from an XML-like description, known as Dialog description language. Through this description language, we can create very complex Dialog boxes containing other widgets and boxes. The downside is that it involves much more work compared to what we've discussed till now.

Copy the following code in some file and save it with a .sh extension, say *filename.sh*:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash

# dialog description assigned to an environmental variable.
Export MAIN_DIALOG='

<vbox>

<text wrap="true" width-chars="50" >
<label>Time has gone, song is over, thought I had something more to say.</label>
</text>
<text use-askup="true">
<label><b>FLOSS rulz my friend!!!</b></label>
</text>
<hbox>
<button ok></button>
<button cancel></button>
</hbox>
</vbox>
'
```

gtkdialog3 --program=MAIN_DIALOG

Now, make *filename.sh* executable and run it to see Gtkdialog in action.

Figure 13 shows the outputs after executing the Xmessage and Gtkdialog commands/scripts.

So we have seen how we can transform any command-line application into a user-friendly graphical application. This is not only useful to put life into older console-oriented utilities but also for the programs you write yourself. In fact, many existing GNU/Linux applications, ranging from installers to kernel configuration utilities, employ these utilities. **END** 

Resources

- dialog home page: invisible-island.net/dialog
- Xdialog home page: xdialog.dyns.net
- gtkdialog home page: linux.ptt.hu/~pipas/gtkdialog/index.html
- kdialog tutorial: techbase.kde.org/Development/Tutorials/Shell_Scripting_with_KDE_Dialogs#Introduction_and_Scope

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